

The Glorious King of Tantras, the Secret Blaze of the Ḍākinī

Śrī Ḍākinī Guhyajvala Tantra Rāja · Toh 408 · Derge Kangyur

དཔལ་མཁའ་འགྲོ་གསང་བ་འབར་བའི་རྒྱ་ཀླིང་པོ།

The Glorious King of Tantras, the Secret Blaze of the Ḍākinī, known in Sanskrit as the Śrī Ḍākinī Guhyajvala Tantra Rāja and in Tibetan as Dpal Mkha' 'gro ma gsang ba 'bar ba'i rgyud kyi rgyal po, is a tantric scripture belonging to the class of highest yoga tantra and centering on the Ḍākinīs — enlightened female wisdom figures who play a central role in Vajrayāna practice. The text is structured as a dialogue in which the nature and classifications of the Ḍākinīs, mothers, secrets, and tantras are systematically enumerated, with particular attention to the empowerments, channels, winds, and other elements of tantric contemplative practice associated with the path to great bliss. It opens with the characteristic invocatory exclamation "Kye — alalaho!" and proceeds to outline four Ḍākinīs, three mothers, six secrets, eight tantras, and nineteen kings of tantra, framing these within a graduated system of empowerments designed to uproot increasingly subtle forms of conceptual grasping. This text is Toh 408 in the Kangyur, catalogued among the tantric scriptures of that collection.

Translated and edited.

In the language of India: Śrī Ḍākinī Guhyajvala Tantra Rāja. In the language of Tibet: The Glorious King of Tantras, the Secret Blaze of the Ḍākinī. Homage to glorious great bliss.

Kye — alalaho! Kye — alalaho!

Who are the Ḍākinīs, who are the mothers, what are the secrets, the tantras, and the kings? Listen, O bodhisattva! There are four Ḍākinīs, three mothers, six secrets, eight tantras, and the kings are taught as nineteen.

First, the division of the Ḍākinīs: in order to abandon coarse conceptuality, the first consists of bodily forms and hand-emblems associated with the vase empowerment.

In order to abandon bodily forms and hand-emblems, the second Ḍākinī is associated with the secret empowerment and comprises winds, channels, and the like, together with caṇḍālī.

For those of lesser capacity, body and hand-emblems, winds and channels and the like, color and shape — in order to abandon even these, the third is the secret *ḍākinī*: associated with wisdom and primordial wisdom, she is the taste of innate joy.

From these *ḍākinīs* in sequence, a subtle form is given to those of lesser capacity. Body, mind, and sensation, together with pleasure — in order to abandon great bliss that transcends these, there is self-aware primordial wisdom: the taste of the emptiness of the nature of mind. That is the fourth *ḍākinī*, beyond the reach of all that is known and spoken. From that, the fifth and so forth.

These *ḍākinīs* in sequence function as follows: bodily forms and hand-emblems serve as the antidote to coarseness; winds, channels, and the like dispel the vase empowerment; bliss dispels winds and channels; self-aware emptiness dispels bliss; and the two form bodies dispel emptiness. Thus the higher is said to be the antidote to the lower.

Coarseness, aggregates, and the like are the cause for the vase empowerment; the vase empowerment is the cause for the secret empowerment; it is definitively the cause for the third secret. Bliss generates self-awareness, and cause and result are thus established. The four results and the four adversarial factors proceed in sequence through the *ḍākinīs*.

The mothers are of three kinds. With great attachment, the Blessed One — with great aversion, the Blessed One — with great delusion, the Blessed One — and pride and the like are similar. Because an extraordinary child arises, they are said to be called "mothers." One who is an unworthy vessel hears the secret proclaimed, and an extraordinary terror is aroused; because it is thus aroused, they are called "mother." Because, within a single birth, one becomes a buddha and an extraordinary son is generated, therefore they are called "mother." The ordinary teaching is known from the mouth of the guru; thereafter the secret is to be taught.

The six nectars (*amṛta*) are the secrets: form, sound, smell, taste, tactile objects, and likewise phenomena.

The tantra is the essence of the four empowerments, and the subject-matter and its expression are taught as eightfold.

The fifth secret is the five kings. View, conduct, the path of union, cause and result, the grounds, and so forth — these nineteen are said to be kings.

Now, O Kye, great hero of fearlessness: if a yakṣa form, a rākṣasa form, or further, forms of māras and the like appear in various manifestations, what is one to do? If forms of gods, nāgas, and the like appear in pleasant guise, what is one to do? If the sound of yakṣas and the sound of rākṣasas, utterly terrifying sounds, ring out, what then is one to do? If the sound of Brahmā or the sound of a swan, melodious and lovely, arises, what is one to do? If the smell of vultures, the smell of musk, or foul stench and the like arise, what is one to do? If the scent of saffron, sandalwood, camphor, and the like, fragrant and sweet, arises, what is one to do? If nectar and the like, sixty varieties and more, excellent tastes appear, what is one to do? If foul stench and the like, inferior flavors of various kinds, appear, what is one to do? If tactile objects such as iron needles and the like, rough sensations, arise, what is one to do? If fine silk and the like, soft sensations contacting the body, arise, what is one to do? The phenomena of the world in all their variety —

phenomena beyond the world — these too are displayed. What am I to do with them?

The Blessed One declared: When ugly forms appear, do not give rise to anger; when beautiful forms appear, do not give rise to desire. Toward them, display the mudrā of the body. If a response comes, it is certainly an emanation of a hero or a ḍākinī bearing attainment (siddhi, Skt. siddhi). If no response comes, it is an obstruction sent by māra. Then undertake the ritual for dispelling māra. The skilled one must apply this with regard to all.

Do not give rise to craving for pleasant sounds, and do not become angry at frightening sounds. Toward them, hold the mind in equanimity and examine them by means of vajra-song. Likewise, do not become attached to fine fragrances, and do not become angry at foul odors. Examine them by resting in equanimous awareness, and display toward them the mudrā of scent. If a response comes, it is an emanation of a ḍākinī; if no response comes, it is an emanation of māra.

Do not partake of pleasant tastes, and do not cast away unpleasant ones. Examine by resting in meditative equipoise, and display toward them the mudrā of taste. Likewise, know each in its distinct particularity. In the same way, apply the Dharma mudrā to Dharma phenomena and, having examined them, dispel the māras.

The māras that arise in the body are likewise to be recognized by their color and form.

As for receiving attainments at the outset: with the eye, form; with the ear, sound; with the nose, scent; with the tongue, taste; with the body, tactile sensation; with the mind, Dharma phenomena — the one who holds the conduct should receive the attainments.

Thereafter, the māras are to be dispelled: either by abiding in the citadel of emptiness, or by dispelling them through the four enlightened activities. By means of water, pleasure, smoothness, and so forth, the inner māras are dispelled.

From the lotus-bile above to the gathering of the upper gate, those endowed with winds enter the gate of the head. Take up this tantra well, entrusted to you. If one acts in this way, attainment is obtained.

The glorious King of Tantras, the Secret Blazing Tantra of the Ḍākinī, is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The opening phrase "Translated and edited" renders the standard colophon formula for revision and checking, placed here at the very beginning as it appears in the manuscript.

The term caṇḍālī is retained in Sanskrit as it is a technical term of the completion-stage yoga referring to the inner heat practice.

The phrase "Kye — alalaho" is a tantric exclamation of wonder and is left untranslated as it is a ritual vocalization rather than a lexical phrase.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end; this passage is clearly a portion of a longer tantra and the translation faithfully ends where the Tibetan ends.

The nineteen kings are named as a total count across view, conduct, path of union, cause, result, and grounds; the precise enumeration of all nineteen is not spelled out here in this passage and is presumably elaborated elsewhere in the text.

- The passage "ལྷ་མོ་རྒྱ་ཆུང་གི་སྤྲེལ་བའི་ཕྱི་དྲུག་ཀླུ་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ཡིན་པ་དང་། རྒྱ་ཆུང་གི་སྤྲེལ་བའི་ཕྱི་དྲུག་ཀླུ་པ་ལྟ་བུ་ཡིན་པ་དང་།" is physiologically technical and employs tantric inner-body terminology. "ལྷ་མོ་རྒྱ་ཆུང་" is literally "lotus-bile," likely referring to the navel or a specific cakra locality; the passage describes the movement of wind (*prāṇa*) through inner channels toward the crown gate, following tantric subtle-body doctrine. The rendering is necessarily close to the Tibetan because no standard canonical commentary has been identified to resolve the anatomical referents with certainty.

The title "गङ्गाधरसिद्धिस्तोत्रम्" — rendered as "the glorious King of Tantras, the Secret Blazing Tantra of the Ḍākinī" — is the colophon title of the work; no widely attested Sanskrit back-formation for this title has been identified.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.